



PILLAR 8

POWER BILL PAIN

“Change happens when the pain
of staying the same is greater
than the pain of change.”

— TONY ROBBINS

Build the pain. The relief sells itself.



POWER BILL PAIN

Pillar 8 of 12 • Presentation

THE GOAL

By the end of this pillar, the customer should think: “wow — I had no idea I was getting smashed this hard. There’s no way I’m going to keep paying this for 25 years.” The calculator does most of the work — your job is to educate them first, walk their bill, then let the numbers land. This is a pain pillar, not a sales pillar. Build the weight of the pain, then transition to Pillar 9 (Savings Reveal) as the relief.

“Wow — I had no idea I was getting smashed this hard. There’s no way I’m going to keep paying this for 25 years.”

WHY IT MATTERS

- **Builds the only pain anchor in the entire presentation.** Every other pillar has been positive (rapport, gear, design, warranties). This is the one moment where you let the customer feel the cost of doing nothing. Without it, the savings reveal in Pillar 9 has nothing to push against.
- **Cashes in on the bill submission from earlier.** The customer submitted their bill before the appointment. Pillar 6 used the usage side. This pillar uses the cost side — rates, total spend, projected 25-year cost.
- **Sets up the savings reveal as relief, not as a sales pitch.** After the customer sees they’ll need to earn six figures+ before tax just to pay their power bill, the Pillar 9 savings reveal lands as “thank god there’s a way out” — not as a salesperson selling them something.

TONALITY (CRITICAL)

DIRECT, KNOWING, “CAN YOU BELIEVE THIS” ENERGY

This is the one pillar where the rep gets to be the most direct. By this point, you’ve built full credibility across Pillars 1–7 — you’ve earned the right to comment honestly on what the customer is being charged. The tonality is a friend telling them they’re in a really bad situation right now — and that there’s a much better place they can be. Not a salesperson manufacturing outrage. Not a knowing wink. Genuine concern, delivered honestly.

- **Direct, not aggressive.** “Yeah, you’re getting smashed on this rate” lands as honest. “Those bastards are robbing you blind” reads as performance.
- **Light chuckles + headshakes are the tonality.** The numbers are absurd — let your reaction show that. A small laugh on the “huge pre-tax number” reveal lands harder than a serious tone.
- **Don’t labour the pain.** Build it, let it land, then transition. Customers shut down if you sit in the pain too long.



— **End with a chuckle, not a hard sell.** “I assume you guys don’t want to fork over another \$[X]...” with a light laugh primes the relief in Pillar 9.

Scripting note

This pillar has 3 sections: (1) the education slide on why bills keep going up, (2) the actual bill walk-through (rates and total spend), (3) the calculator that projects 25-year cost. The education slide is mostly dot-points, the bill walk-through is improvised based on what’s on their bill, and the calculator is mostly scripted because the structure of walking Year 1 → Year 25 has to be consistent.

TRANSITION FROM PILLAR 7

Pillar 7 closed with the rep saying just “Perfect” after the customer confirmed all six guarantees sounded good. Pillar 8 opens with a single clean pivot — jumping into the bill, with a quick education detour first.

“Alright guys — so now we’re going to jump into your bill and everything like that. One thing we’re going to do quickly though, just to educate you on what’s actually happening with the power market overall — because honestly, most people have no clue why their bills keep going up the way they do.”

Tonality: calm + casual confidence. Said like one continuous thought, not a stacked “before we do X, but actually before that, we’ve got to do Y” structure. The “most people have no clue” framing makes the customer want to be on the inside of the knowledge.

Then move straight into Slide 1 (the education slide).

SLIDE 1: THE REAL COST OF POWER (EDUCATION)

This slide shows: electricity price increases by region/year, the AGL (or equivalent retailer) pie chart breaking down where every \$100 actually goes (\$35 pure profit, \$34 network costs, \$15 advertising/marketing, \$12 actual electricity, \$4 tax depreciation), and the closing line: “all these power companies run the same playbook: squeeze the customer, maximise profits.” Purpose is to flip the customer’s mental frame from “power is just expensive” to “power companies are screwing me specifically.”

Beat 1: Open with the question

Don’t lecture — ask. Get the customer to engage with the question before you give them the answer. Their guess (usually “dunno, just goes up”) makes the reveal land harder.

“Quick question for you guys — do you even know what’s happening with the power market? Like, do you know why bills have literally doubled in the past 10 years?”

Tonality: curious. Genuine question — let them answer.

Almost every customer says some version of “dunno, it just keeps going up” or “rising costs I guess” or “the government.” Whatever they say, nod, then move into Beat 2.

Beat 2: Drop the real reason (dot points)

Now educate them. Walk these dot points off the slide:

- “Honestly — it’s actually because the power companies are just trying to make more and more profit, year after year”
- “Look at this — AGL alone, their profit doubled in a single year. Doubled.”
- “Electricity price increases announced for July: 10–12% in VIC, 20–24% in QLD and NSW — just this year alone”
- “And the wild part — this is happening every year. Compounding. That’s why your bill has doubled in 10 years.”

Tonality: matter-of-fact + slight headshake. You’re sharing facts, not pitching. The numbers are doing the work.

Localisation note: the AGL example and the VIC/QLD/NSW figures above are AU-specific. You would sub in the dominant retailer in your country (e.g., a major US, UK, or NZ provider) and the most recent rate-hike announcements for the customer’s actual region. The slide text and your dot-point references should both be tailored to the customer’s state, country, and local retailer — not generic global figures.

Beat 3: The \$12 of every \$100 reveal

This is the philosophical anchor of the slide. Don’t set it up with a “guess how much” question — the customer can already see the pie chart on screen. Just point at it and deliver the reveal directly.

“So look at this with me — for every \$100 you spend on your power bill, only \$12 actually goes to the electricity itself. The other \$88 is pure profit, network costs, and marketing. Your bill should realistically be 88% less than what you’re paying right now.”

Tonality: certainty + slight knowing chuckle. Said directly — the chart is already on screen, your job is to land the punchline. The chuckle keeps it warm rather than aggressive.

Then deliver the AGL transparency kicker:

“And by the way — this is just AGL. They’re the only ones actually transparent enough to release this data publicly. I can’t even speak to what these other companies are doing — but if AGL is comfortable showing you it’s \$12 out of \$100, imagine what these other massive conglomerates are hiding. It’s almost certainly worse.”

Tonality: matter-of-fact + slight headshake. The kicker is doing real work — it makes AGL look like the “honest” one and implies every other retailer is even worse. Lands as logical inference, not accusation.

If outside AU, swap AGL for whatever power company is dominant in your area.

Beat 4: The frame lock-in

Close the slide on the bottom-line frame — same playbook, every retailer.

“All these power companies run the exact same playbook: squeeze the customer, maximise profits. Your hard-earned money isn’t paying for electricity — it’s filling some rich CEO’s pockets. That’s the reality of it.”

Tonality: certainty + slight headshake. Said as a flat industry observation, not as a rant. Then transition straight into the bill walk-through.



SLIDE 2: THEIR ACTUAL BILL (COST WALK-THROUGH)

This is the cost side of the bill walk-through (Pillar 6 Slide 3 was the usage side). Open the bill on screen, walk the rates, react honestly to what you see, then determine their average annual bill ready for the calculator. The reactions are the moment — this is where the rep gets to be most direct.

CRITICAL: HAVE THE CUSTOMER'S BILL OPEN ON SCREEN BEFORE OPENING THIS SLIDE.

Don't spend 30 seconds fumbling to find it — the energy from Slide 1 will dissipate. Have it loaded.

Beat 1: Open the bill

Pivot from the education slide into their specific bill.

"Alright — so now let's actually look at what specifically you guys are paying. Let's look at your bill, see what rates you're getting hit with."

Tonality: matter-of-fact + casual. Said like a quick procedural step.

Beat 2: Walk the bill with genuine concern

This is the moment. Walk through the bill, highlight the pain points honestly. The tonality is genuine concern — you're a friend looking at the bill with them and pointing out where they're being charged too much. Not performed, not aggressive. Concerned.

- "Okay, so you guys are on a peak rate of [X] cents per kWh — that's actually pretty high."
- "Oh man — how long have they been hitting you with this rate?"
- "And this daily supply charge — [X] cents a day just for being connected to the grid."
- "Yeah man, you're definitely getting smashed on this one."

Tonality: genuine concern. The voice should sound like a friend who's genuinely worried about what they're seeing — light headshake, slight pause on the bigger numbers. NOT outraged, NOT performed. Just concerned. The customer should feel like they're finally hearing an honest take from someone who knows the market and actually cares.

If their rates are actually reasonable, don't fake-react. Just say "okay, your rates aren't the worst I've seen, but the total is still going to add up — which is what we're about to look at." The pain still lands at the calculator stage even with reasonable rates.

Beat 3: Determine the average annual bill

Lock in their average annual spend so it can go straight into the calculator. Lean slightly high — account for seasonal spikes. The customer should hear it as a fair estimate, not a lowball.

"Alright, let's try to figure out roughly what you're paying per year on average, based on these bills."

Tonality: matter-of-fact + casual. Said like a quick procedural step before the calculator.

- Look at last quarter's total + the past 12 months if visible
- Calculate average annual spend — lean slightly high to account for seasonal spikes



- Confirm with the customer: “So you’re looking at roughly \$[X] a year on power, fair?”
- Get their verbal confirmation on the number before plugging it into the calculator

The annual figure has to be locked in by them, not assigned by you. Their confirmation is what makes the calculator output land as their real number.

SLIDE 3: THE CALCULATOR (THE COST OF DOING NOTHING)

This is the centrepiece of the entire pillar. The calculator takes their annual electricity bill + their marginal tax rate and projects forward 25 years at an indicative 8% annual price increase, showing both the cumulative cost AND the pre-tax earnings required to cover it. This is where the customer sees the real, compounding cost of doing nothing — and it lands harder than any verbal projection ever could.

Beat 1: Open the calculator + plug in the bill

Open the calculator with their annual bill ready to enter.

“Alright — so now let’s actually plug your numbers into a calculator and show you exactly what this is going to cost you over the long run. Because the bill you’re paying right now is one thing — but compounding it forward is where it gets ridiculous.”

Tonality: calm + matter-of-fact. Said like you’re about to show them something they need to see.

Plug in their annual bill figure that you confirmed in Slide 2 Beat 3. Don’t guess — use the number they confirmed.

Beat 2: Ask the tax question (fully scripted)

Get their marginal tax rate. This is critical — the higher the tax bracket, the more devastating the pre-tax earnings number becomes.

“Quick one before I plug this in — what tax rate are you guys on? Like roughly, do you know what your marginal tax rate is?”

Tonality: casual + matter-of-fact. Asked like a quick procedural question, not a sales setup.

Most customers know roughly. Some are in high brackets (47%), some are mid-bracket (32–37%), some are lower (19–30%). Whatever they say, plug it in. If they don’t know, default to 30% and note “we’ll go with 30% — that’s a fair middle estimate.”

Beat 3: Walk the year-by-year table

This is the build. Walk the customer through Year 1 → Year 2 → Year 5 → Year 10. The compounding is the story — each year their bill goes up even if their usage stays exactly the same.

- “Okay so look at this — in your first year, you’d be paying \$[X]”
- “Year two — even if you used the exact same power, did absolutely nothing different — it goes up to \$[X]”
- “Five years from now — your bill looks like this”
- “Ten years from now — this is what it looks like. And by year 10, you would have spent \$[cumulative] before tax just on power”



Tonality: certainty + slight headshake on the bigger numbers. Let the table do the work — you're just narrating what the customer is already seeing.

Beat 4: Pre-handle the 8% push-back

Most customers don't push back, but if they do, here's the answer.

- If they question the 8%: "Yeah, totally fair question"
- Highlight the footnote on screen: "based on industry forecasts and the past decade of recorded price changes"
- "This isn't even our calculator — it's based off direct industry data. You can't really argue with the actual recorded price changes."
- Optional: "If anything, it's actually conservative — recent years have been higher than 8%"

Tonality: certainty + casual. Said like you're just pointing them at the data — not defending. Most customers accept the figure once they see the source.

Beat 5: The 10-year doubling anchor (fully scripted)

This is the philosophical anchor of the calculator. The 10-year doubling is true regardless of the customer's starting bill — the math always doubles within 10 years at 8% compounding. Use it.

"And here's the wild part — this always pretty much doubles after 10 years no matter what the starting bill is. It literally doubled over the past 10 years, so you know it's going to double over the next 10 as well. That's just what compounding does."

Tonality: certainty + matter-of-fact. Said like the obvious truth — because it is.

Beat 6: The 25-year pre-tax reveal (fully scripted)

This is the moment. Scroll down to the 25-year card and deliver the headline number with weight.

"And then look at this. Over the next 25 years — if you change literally nothing — you're going to spend \$[25-year cumulative] on power. And to pay for that, before tax, you'd need to earn \$[25-year pre-tax]. Just to pay your power bill."

Tonality: certainty + slight headshake. Slow down on the pre-tax number — let it land. The customer needs a moment to absorb it.

DO NOT fill the silence after the reveal. Let it sit for 2–3 seconds. The pause is what makes the number land. If you rush to the next beat, you waste the moment.

Beat 7: The dead-money contrast (fully scripted)

This beat is the bridge into Pillar 9. Once the 25-year number has landed, point out the obvious: they're going to fork out the cost of a solar system on power bills well before 25 years anyway. The choice isn't whether to spend the money — it's whether to spend it on a system that pays them back, or on bills that just keep getting bigger.

"And actually look at this — you'd already be forking out the cost of a solar system, well and truly, within just the first [X] years. Just on power bills. Same money, either way."

"So in one scenario, you spend that money on a system that's then paying you back for the next 25 years. In the other, you just have a bigger bill next year, and the year after, and the year after that. There's really no middle option here — you're paying that money one way or the other."



Tonality: matter-of-fact + genuine concern. Said as a flat observation, not a sales pitch — you're just pointing out the math the customer can see for themselves on screen. The "same money, either way" framing is what does the work.

To find the [X] years figure: look at the cumulative cost column on the calculator and find the year it crosses the price of an equivalent solar system. For most customers this is around year 6–8. Use whatever year their cumulative cost crosses the system price — it's a real number from their own data, not a sales claim.

THE PAIN CLOSE + TRANSITION (FULLY SCRIPTED)

After the 25-year reveal lands, close the pain with a light chuckle and pivot straight into Pillar 9. The chuckle is critical — it tells the customer the rep ALSO finds the number absurd, which builds alliance. Then the pivot to Pillar 9 lands as relief, not as a sales push.

Beat 1: The chuckle close

Acknowledge the absurdity of the number with a light chuckle. The whole point is to NOT make it salesy. You're just checking they've registered the number — you're not selling against it. The chuckle is what keeps it warm.

"I assume you guys don't want to fork over another \$[X], or whatever it is, over the next [X] years just to pay your power bill?"

Tonality: light chuckle + casual confidence. Asked rhetorically — the answer is obvious. The chuckle is what makes it land warm. Don't re-say the exact figure — the customer just saw it. Re-saying it reads as labouring the pain.

Both the amount AND the timeframe are situational. For the timeframe: if they've told you it's their forever home earlier in the appointment, use 25 years. If they've said they're only there for the next 10 years, use 10. Anchor the number to what they've actually told you about their situation — that's what makes the close land as personal rather than scripted.

For the amount: use a vague phrasing like "another couple hundred K" or "another six figures" or "all that money" depending on what the calculator showed. The vagueness is intentional — it acknowledges the figure without re-quoting it.

Customer almost always says "no" or "hell no" or laughs.

Beat 2: The pivot to Pillar 9 (fully scripted)

Pivot the moment they say no. Don't pause, don't labour the pain further. The relief comes immediately.

"Yeah, no doubt — and the good thing is, there's no reason you would have to anymore. Let me show you now."

Tonality: calm + casual confidence. Said warmly — you're offering them the way out, because you are. "The good thing is" is the relief signal. "Let me show you now" is the action signal that primes them for Pillar 9.

Then move straight into Pillar 9 (Solar Savings Breakdown). The customer is now mentally primed for the savings reveal as relief, not as a sales pitch.



FAILURE MODES (DO NOT DO)

- **Performing outrage instead of being direct.** “Those bastards are robbing you blind” reads as theatrical and manufactured. “You’re getting smashed on this rate” lands as honest. Direct, not aggressive.
- **Labouring the pain — that’s when it gets salesy.** Once the 25-year number lands, the customer just needs to acknowledge it. Re-saying the figure, hammering “can you believe that?”, or rephrasing the pain three different ways flips the moment from honest into salesy. Build the pain, let it land, get the acknowledgment, pivot.
- **Skipping the education slide.** The \$12-of-\$100 reveal flips the customer’s frame from “power is just expensive” to “power companies are screwing me specifically.” Without that frame shift, the bill walk-through reads as informational instead of as outrageous.
- **Filling the silence after the 25-year reveal.** The pause after “you’d need to earn \$[X] before tax” is what makes the number land. Rushing to the next beat wastes the moment.
- **Skipping the tax question or defaulting to a low rate.** The pre-tax earnings number is what does the heaviest pain work. If the customer is in a 37% bracket and you default to 30%, you cost yourself the most powerful figure on the screen.
- **Closing the pain seriously instead of with a chuckle.** The chuckle is what builds alliance — “we both find this absurd.” Closing the pain with serious tone reads as “the salesperson is trying to scare me” and the customer’s guard goes up just before Pillar 9.

TRANSITION INTO PILLAR 9 (SOLAR SAVINGS BREAKDOWN)

Pillar 8 closes with the customer having seen the 25-year cost of doing nothing — and the rep delivering the chuckle pivot: “let’s get to the other option.” Pillar 9 now lands as the relief, the alternative to the huge pre-tax number they just saw on screen. The pain is the setup. The savings are the payoff.

No additional verbal switch needed — the chuckle pivot from the pain close IS the transition.

Remember: this pillar is the only pain anchor in the whole presentation. Build the weight, let it land, then pivot to relief. No pain = no relief = no close.